



Selected Poems

2021–2023

JACOB DAUM

Poems

First

Petals fall in circles
Winding down the page
Hueish glow
Traces the outline
Of your descent
Long after you've fallen

Second

Rise
and fall
Swirling grey
Gentle push
Edges dull

Cloud rests
Settled hue
Pencil shavings
Ink pools

Eyelids droop
Purple swells
Veins wind
Rancid stench

Branches reach
Offering leaves
Gold in the sun
Splinter to your touch

Windchimes stammer
Rustled by the stream
What once was
And will never be

Third

Shiver down your spine
Metal on metal
Layered grey death
Clashes with the clock
Ticking with the sparks
Living from the embers
Of voices fleeting
Into the dark

Fourth

Cloth patchwork
Of lives lived
Memories buried
In the earth
Where you will rest too

Balloon set free
Blind in the wind
Watch it fade
And hold it
In your heart
Of hearts

Ninth

Eyes open
Eyes shut
Space stretches
And tightens
Irises bloom
Irises wither
Her face
Etched in copper
Is fixed
Like the cobweb
That reaches
Like a finger
From the corner
Of my garden
Past the old
tangled trellis
And the ivy
That climbs it
To cover me
Like a blanket
And mouth
Soft words

Twelfth

Detail falls out
Pressed into skin
Sinking beneath
So time might rest
And bask in the glow
That etches your shape
As candlewax pools
And whispers fade

Thirteenth

Thumb smearing through ashes
Flowers grow around
Bold round edges
Velvet brushing skin
Leaves soot trails
That wither like blossoms
And sing like time

Fourteenth

Boulder unmoving
Draped in mossy green
Returns my push
Striking cold to the bone
Where my pulse hides
And shifts through the timbre
Of gravestones unspoken
That cast no shadows
As the midday bell tolls
And the grasses grow thicker
I'm but a silhouette
Carved in your smile

Nineteenth

Red lattice
Capillaries shimmer
Reaching from earth
To encircle the thread
That holds us together
And comforts you
In your dreams
When I'm not there

Twenty-first

Sink
Into the watercress
Koi lap at your feet
Leap between lillipads
Minds blend to sand
Shifting through the somber
Nights that speak
In hushed voices,
Cursive notes with tails
Leave more missing
Than here

Twenty-second

Deep well,
Little things sprout
And shiver
Nourished by your shade,
That crawls
Under skin
And eats until eyelids droop
And nothing remains
But an ox through the valley
Dragging his sled, and
snowflakes, shapeless
Lost in the glint
Of scorched earth

Twenty-third

Frail skeleton,
Melt to your frame
And drift away,
Into the light
So you can shimmer
In my eyes
And feel the thread
That draws me to you

Twenty-Fourth

Warm turn
Of candlelight to ember
Hair stands straight
And smoke winds
As we jostle for position
Silhouettes painted on the wall

Twenty-Seventh

Take me apart
Until I'm nothing left
But a little blinking light
You carry in your palm
And remember
When it hurts